

State of the States

SEPTEMBER 28, 2009

The Seventh State of the States Report reflects the inexorable pace of change across India. States can no longer rest on legacy dividends. Leaders are thus losing stature, and tragically those at the bottom of the pit are mired in sloth.



“The brunt of the inclusive growth phenomenon is borne by the middle class. It gives an impression that the Government is nonchalant and not serious in its approach towards the problems faced by people.”

I. SHANKAR, via www.indiatoday.in

State of Affairs

The Seventh State of the States Report demonstrates that the charisma of a chief minister is not enough to make his state the best (“State of the States”, September 28). Magnetic personalities like Narendra Modi or YSR Reddy have not been able to bring their states to the top five. Similarly, the big states at the bottom five have been stagnating for the last seven years—the good image of Nitish Kumar and the poor leadership of Mayawati have yielded similar results. The most important message that the survey conveys is that a state’s performance is an amalgam of complex stimulants going beyond charismatic leadership.

Y.G. CHOUKSEY, Pune

The report encompasses



SHAILESH RAVAL/www.indiatodaymag.com

Sporting a New Look

Narendra Modi’s entry into cricket administration is a welcome development (“Hitting a Double Ton”, September 28). Being a good administrator, he would do the utmost for the development of the sport in the state. One hopes that Modi will be able to create an environment where sportspersons get respect and pride.

VINOD DIXIT, via www.indiatoday.in

Not only ministers, but all elected representatives have enough responsibility towards governance. There should be a rule barring elected representatives—either to Parliament or even state assemblies or municipal bodies—from occupying any post in any other organisation.

S.C. AGRAWAL, Delhi

newer parameters and innovative methods to adjudicate the best and the worst states of India. The states bagging the top ranks strive to be dynamic in governance while laggards like Bihar, Uttar Pradesh and Orissa couldn’t care less about improving their lot. Punjab may find it difficult to retain its number one position as the tired soil syndrome and severe groundwater depletion is affecting agriculture, the backbone of its success.

N. VIJAYARAGHAVAN,
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If India is to progress, the states that continue to remain at the bottom need to climb up the progress ladder. However, some of the states at the top have not been able to harness their potential to the

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